Fairly's Adventure

COMPLETE GAME PLAY | ATARI 2600 | ONE PLAYER | NTSC



The adventure begins. Press Fire to enter the dungeon.

Five levels. Five dragons. One great treasure.

Guide Fairly through a dangerous dungeon. Defeat monsters, collect gold, improve your wand and armor, and learn each dragon's warnings. Beyond the fifth dragon lies a treasure vault.

You begin with: 5 health, 3 lives, wand tier 1, armor tier 0 and 0 gold.

1 Start playing

Action	Joystick / console	Stella keyboard*
Move and face	Up, down, left or right	Arrow keys
Cast / open / buy	Fire	Space
Restart	Reset switch	F2

*The project's keyboard setup. Emulator controls can be remapped. Connect a joystick to controller port 1.

Press Fire on the title screen. Release the button between shots: holding Fire does not auto-fire. There is a short cooldown and only one active wand shot at a time. Shots travel in the direction Fairly faces.

Your status display

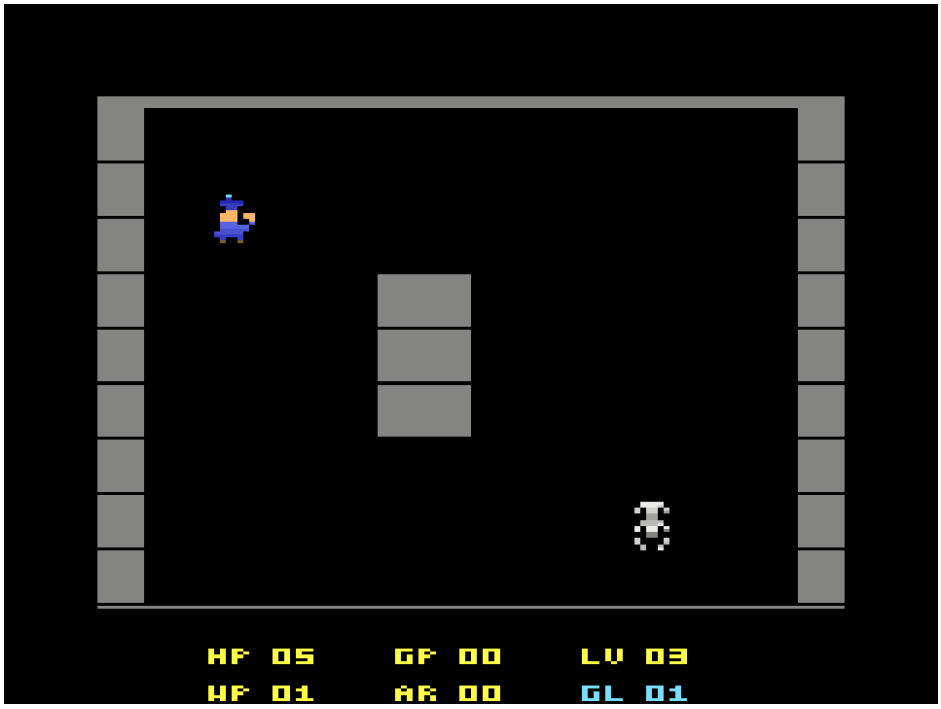


HUD detail: six statistics remain visible below the room.

Field	Meaning
HP	Health. Maximum 5 throughout the game.
GP	Gold. Carry at most 25.
LV	Total lives remaining. Maximum 10.
WP	Wand tier.
AR	Armor tier.
GL	Game level, 1-5. Its text color changes by level.

A bright hit sound and enemy flash confirm damage. A dull tick signals a blocked or ineffective shot.

2 Explore the dungeon



An ordinary dungeon room. Clear its enemies to unlock the exits.

Defeat every enemy in a combat room, then approach its chest and press Fire. Leave through an open doorway to discover another encounter. Cleared rooms are not stored as a persistent map.

Know your enemies

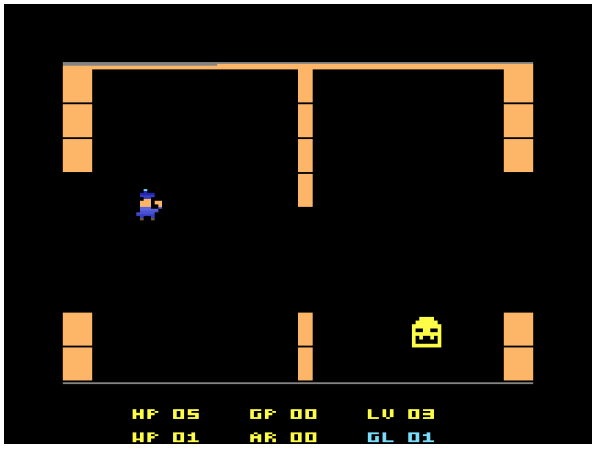
Skeletons switch between wandering and pursuing you. Bats move randomly, including diagonally. Slimes wander, pursue and lunge forward.

Level 1 has one ordinary enemy per room. Later skeleton and slime rooms can have two independent enemies. Movement becomes faster at higher game levels. Quiet rattles, squeaks and bubbling calls identify enemies; combat cues take priority.

Chest rewards

A chest can hold 0-2 gold, 2 HP of healing, wand +1 or armor +1. Healing stops at 5 HP; equipment respects the current level cap. An unusable heal or upgrade can become a gold roll. Some gold chests are empty.

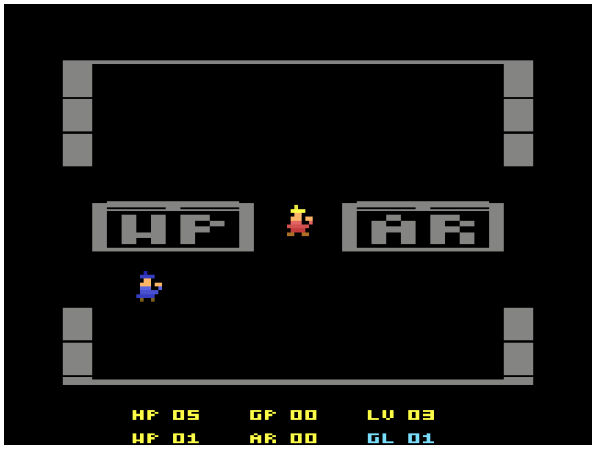
3 Firewalls and shops



Find the opening before the moving firewall reaches you.

A moving wall of fire leaves a gap to pass through. Line up with it as the wall sweeps across the room. Contact costs health, and there is no initial safety period in this room. Firewalls are different from the instantly lethal lava in dragon rooms.

Visit the merchant

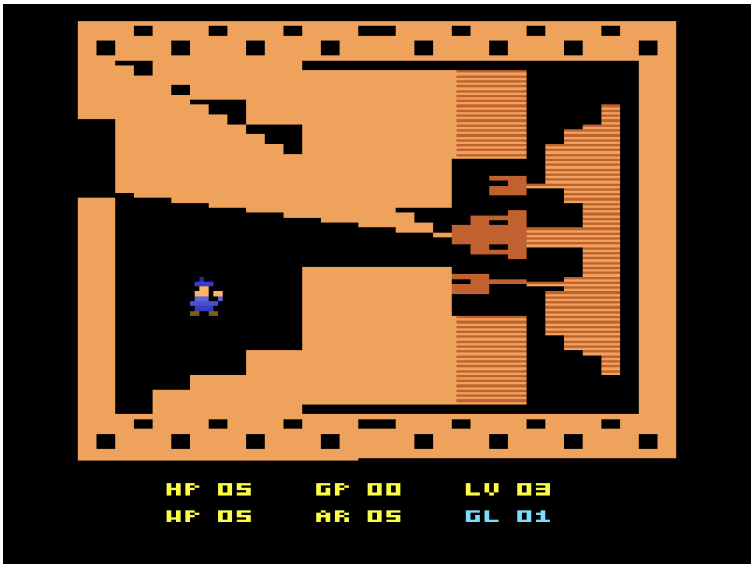


WP chest on the left, merchant in the center, AR chest on the right.

Purchase	Where	Cost
Wand +1 tier	Left WP chest	15 gold
Restore health to 5	Center merchant	5 gold
Armor +1 tier	Right AR chest	15 gold

Approach and press Fire; release between purchases. A rising chime and green flash confirm success. A low buzz and failure flash mean nothing was bought. Full health, capped gear and unaffordable purchases cost no gold.

4 The Dragon

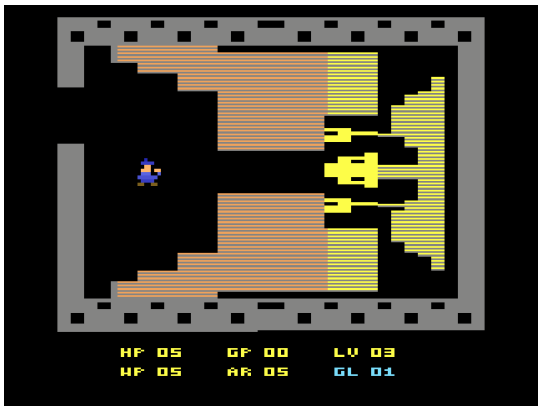


Fire spreads from the mouth into the warned part of the arena.

Warning	Next fire cone
Upper foot draws back	Upper arena
Both feet move	Middle arena
Lower foot draws back	Lower arena

Directions are random and may repeat. Read the feet and listen for the pulsing warning rumble each time. Move out of the warned path before the breath arrives.

Gold means attack



The gold recovery period is your chance to damage the head.

Only head shots during gold recovery damage the dragon. A chime marks this opening. A bright hit sound and white flash confirm damage; other head shots are blocked.

5 Survive and claim the rewards

Lava is always lethal

Touching a permanent orange lava pool immediately costs one life. Armor and invulnerability flashing do not protect you. Lava remains dangerous after the dragon dies, so stay on clear floor when collecting rewards.

Retreat when you need to

Use the opening on the left wall, above the arena's center, to escape. You keep your game level, equipment, gold and lives. A later dragon encounter begins with the dragon at full health.

Two chests and a locked rear door

After defeating the Dragon, two chests appear:

Upper chest: the key to the door behind the dragon.
Lower chest: one guaranteed extra life, plus wand +1 if below the current level cap. The life is awarded independently of the wand upgrade, up to 10 total lives. Each chest can be collected once.

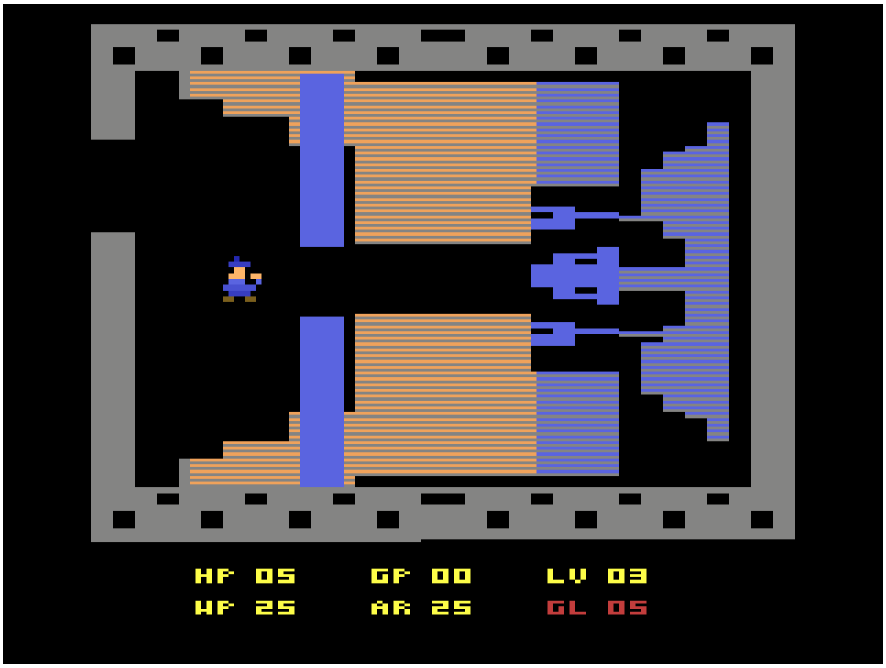
Collect the key and cross the door on the right. Health, lives, gold and gear carry into the next level. The fifth dragon's door leads to the treasure ending.

Armor and damage

Armor tiers 0 and 1 block no damage. Each tier above 1 blocks one point of ordinary-enemy and dragon damage, but a hit always deals at least 1 damage. At game level 2, armor 9 reduces a 10-point hit to 2 HP. Too little armor can make a single hit fatal.

Damage taken = base damage - armor protection, with a minimum of 1.
Armor protection is 0 at armor 0 or 1; otherwise it is armor tier minus 1. Lava ignores this rule.

6 The ice dragon and progression



Level 5: a blue dragon and a slow ice wall with one escape gap.

The level 5 dragon alternates an ice wall with one random fire cone. Each ice sweep has one small gap, chosen high, middle or low. The gap stays at that height until the wall passes.

Ice deals the same armor-scaled damage as fire and freezes Fairly. Movement and shooting stop until the following fire cone ends. That cone might miss, but survival is not guaranteed. Align with the gap using clear floor; never cross lava to reach it.

Game level	Gear cap	Enemy HP	Dragon HP	Base hit
1	5	5	40	5
2	10	19	80	10
3	15	30	150	15
4	20	37	260	20
5	25	71	375	25

The gear cap applies to both wand and armor. Base hit damage applies to ordinary enemies and dragons before armor. Wand damage always equals WP. Health stays capped at 5.

At armor 25, the level 5 dragon's ice and fire each deal 1 damage. Lava still costs a life immediately.

7 Defeat and victory

When you lose a life

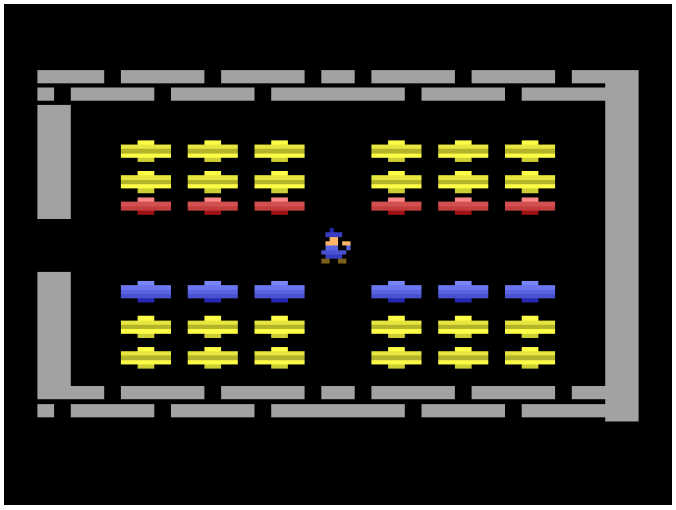
You return with 5 HP and keep your game level, gold, wand and armor. The room resets, including a dragon's full health. Damage to a dragon does not carry between attempts.



The final life lost: the screen shows the game level reached.

A short descending tune plays, then stops. Release Fire and press again to begin a new level 1 adventure with the original starting stats. Reset/F2 also restarts.

The treasure vault



Beyond the fifth dragon: gold, rubies, sapphires and victory music.

Defeat the fifth dragon, collect the key and cross its rear door. Fairly walks to the center automatically while music plays. Movement and shooting are disabled during the celebration. The treasure is decorative, not extra spendable gold. Reset/F2 returns to the title.